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WHICH SECTION SHOULD I READ?

Not sure?
→ 01 - Identify Your Problem

Think in your language first?
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Get stuck while speaking?
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Want to sound more natural?
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Make grammar mistakes?
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Use too many extra words?
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Sound too formal?
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1. Identify Your Problem

Before you start, figure out what is making English difficult for you.

You don't need to improve everything at once. Start with the problem that feels most familiar, then jump to the section that helps you work on it.

Which sounds most like you?

- I know what I want to say, but I translate it from my first language.
- I know the words, but I get stuck while speaking.
- I speak, but my English sounds too formal.
- I make the same grammar mistakes again and again.
- I use too many unnecessary words.
- I rely on basic expressions like “very good” or “very tired.”
- I panic when I make a mistake.

Pick one. Start there.

You can come back to the other sections later. The goal is not to fix everything in one day. It's to make speaking a little easier, one problem at a time.

Quick Win: You don't need a perfect starting point. You just need to know what to work on first.

2. Think in English

The core problem: You think in your first language, translate it, and then speak. That extra step can make you slower and more hesitant.

The goal is not to stop thinking in your first language completely. It's to get better at building simple thoughts directly in English.

Fix 1 - Stop Translating Every Sentence

Instead of planning a sentence in your first language and translating it word by word, try to build the thought directly in simple English.

- “Mujhe bahut bhookh lagi hai” → “I'm starving.”
- “Uska mood off hai” → “He's in a bad mood.”
- “Main thodi der ke liye bahar ja raha hoon” → “I'll be out for a bit.”

You don't need to translate every word. You need to express the meaning.

Fix 2 - The 2–3 Word Start

Don't plan the whole sentence before you speak. Grab two or three useful words and start talking.

- tired + leave + early → “I'm tired. Can I leave early?”
- late + traffic + sorry → “Sorry, traffic was bad.”

Once you start, the rest of the sentence often becomes easier.

Fix 3 - Forgot a Word? Describe It, Don't Stop

You don't need to know every word to keep a conversation going.

- Forgot renew → “I need to make my passport valid again.”
- Forgot colleague → “The person I work with.”
- Forgot postpone → “Can we move the meeting to a later day?”

The goal is to keep communicating, even when a word doesn't come to mind.

Fix 4 - Narrate Your Day

Pick five minutes while cooking, walking, or commuting. Silently describe what you're doing in simple English.

- “I need to boil the water first.”
- “This traffic is so slow today.”

No audience needed. Just practice putting thoughts into English.

Practice: Describe umbrella, refund, and nervous without using the words themselves.

Quick Win: A simple sentence said out loud beats a perfect one stuck in your head.

3. Speak Without Getting Stuck

Sentence Starters

Keep a few ready so you're not starting from zero every time.

- “Honestly, I think...”
- “The thing is...”
- “To be fair...”
- “From what I understand...”
- “I was thinking...”

Fillers Are Fine

A short pause is not a failure.

- “Um...”
- “Let me think...”
- “You know...”
- “So, basically...”
- “Actually...”

Don't force a filler into every sentence. A natural silent pause works too.

Chunk It

Don't build a long sentence all at once. Say it in pieces and keep moving.

Instead of planning:

> “I was thinking that maybe we could go to the market later if you're free.”

Try:

> “I was thinking...” “Maybe we could go to the market...” “Later...” “If you're free.”

Useful blocks:

- “I was thinking...” + “that we could...” + “later today”
- “Do you want to...” + “grab something...” + “before we leave”

Link Your Ideas

Short sentences are fine, but connectors help them flow.

Useful connectors:

because · so · but · although · also · even though · which means · on top of that

- “I wanted to go, but it was raining.”
- “I was tired, so I went home early.”

Practice: Talk about your weekend for one minute. Use two natural pauses and one connector.

Quick Win: Say one piece. Then add the next. You don't need the ending before you start.

4. Sound Natural & Confident

Contractions Are Normal in Casual Speech

- “I am not sure.” → “I'm not sure.”
- “They have already left.” → “They've already left.”

You don't need to avoid full forms, but contractions are common in everyday conversation.

React First, Explain After

Conversations often move faster when you respond briefly before giving your full explanation.

Agreement

- “Exactly.”
- “Totally.”
- “For sure.”

Disagreement

- “Not really.”
- “I don't think so.”

Surprise

- “No way!”
- “Seriously?”
- “Wait, really?”

Small Talk Formula

Greeting → Comment or question → Bounce it back

- “Hey, how was your weekend?”
- “Pretty relaxing. How about you?”
- “Same, I needed the rest.”

Agree or Disagree Without Sounding Rude

Acknowledge the other person's point, then add your own view.

- “I see what you mean, but I think...”
- “That's a fair point, although...”

Stress Changes Meaning

The same sentence can mean different things depending on which word you stress.

- I didn't say he stole it. (Someone else said it.)
- I didn't say he stole it. (I never said that.)
- I didn't say he stole it. (Maybe someone else did.)
- I didn't say he stole it. (Maybe he borrowed it.)
- I didn't say he stole it. (Maybe he stole something else.)

Practice: Say “I never said that” three times, stressing a different word each time.

Quick Win: Don't give every word the same weight. Stress the part that matters.

5. Grammar Mistakes to Fix

These are common phrasing problems. Some are grammatically incorrect; others are understandable but less natural in the intended context.

Common phrasing	Better
I am agree with you	I agree with you
She is having two kids. (meaning she has two children)	She has two kids.
He don't like it	He doesn't like it
Can you explain me this?	Can you explain this to me?
I am reaching in 10 minutes.	I'll be there in 10 minutes.
She was knowing the answer	She knew the answer
I didn't ate	I didn't eat
I am from since morning here	I've been here since morning
It's raining since morning	It's been raining since morning
I am having headache	I have a headache
We are here since 2 years	We've been here for 2 years
Are you understanding?	Do you understand?

A small note: Some phrases, such as “I am not getting it,” can be used in certain contexts. The alternatives above are simply more natural for the meanings intended here.

Quick Win: Read this list once a week until the common corrections start sounding natural to your own ear.

6. Redundant Phrases to Drop

Not every phrase in the left column is grammatically wrong. Some are simply longer than necessary, or a shorter alternative sounds more natural in everyday English.

Longer phrasing	Simpler alternative
Discuss about the plan	Discuss the plan
Repeat again	Repeat / Say it again
Return back	Return
Enter into the room	Enter the room
Free gift	Gift (when “free” adds no useful meaning)
Each and every	Each / Every
Reply back	Reply
Add on more	Add more
Combine together	Combine
Basic fundamentals	Fundamentals
End result	Result
Past history	History
True fact	Fact
Final outcome	Outcome
Advance planning	Planning

Quick Win: If removing the extra word changes nothing, you can usually drop it.

7. Overly Formal Phrases to Loosen Up

Formal English isn't wrong. But in everyday conversations, calls, and chats, simpler wording often sounds more natural.

More formal	More natural in everyday conversation
I would like to inform you that...	Just wanted to let you know...
Kindly revert at the earliest.	Please get back to me soon.
I am in receipt of your message.	Got your message.
This is to inform you that...	Just so you know...
I shall be obliged.	I'd appreciate it.
With reference to the above...	About what I mentioned...
I am extremely grateful.	Thanks so much.
Please find attached herewith.	I've attached...
I would request you to...	Could you please...?
I hereby confirm...	Confirming that...
Please be informed that...	Just a heads-up...
It is my humble opinion...	I think...

Quick Win: Formal English is useful in the right setting. But when you're chatting, speaking on a call, or having a casual conversation, simpler wording often makes you sound more natural.

8. Everyday Sentence Upgrades

You don't need to replace every basic expression. The goal is to build a small bank of alternatives that you genuinely like and can use comfortably.

Basic	A more natural alternative
I am very happy	I'm thrilled
I am very tired	I'm beat
It was very good	It was awesome
It was very bad	It was rough
I am very hungry	I'm starving
That is very easy	That's a piece of cake
I am very confused	I'm lost
That is very expensive	That's pricey
I am very busy	I'm slammed
That is very boring	That's dull
I am very nervous	I'm on edge
That is very interesting	That's fascinating
I am very sure	I'm positive
That is very difficult	That's tough
I am very excited	I'm pumped

A small note: These alternatives are not always interchangeable. Some are more informal, stronger, or more expressive than the original.

Practice: Upgrade these three out loud:

- “I'm very hungry.”
- “The movie was very good.”
- “I'm very busy today.”

Quick Win: Build a small bank of five or six upgrades you genuinely like. Don't try to replace every “very.”

9. Secret Techniques - Interviews & Calls

Phone Openers

- “Hi, this is [Name] calling about...”
- “Is this a good time to talk?”
- “I'll follow up over email.”

Interview Openers

These give you a second to think without sounding unprepared.

- “Sure. Currently, I'm [role/study], and I've been focused on...”
- “That's a good question. Let me think about that for a second.”

Work Update Formula

What's done → What's left → When it'll be ready

> “I've finished the first section. I just need to review the second part. It should be done by tomorrow.”

Other Useful Lines

- “Just a quick update. I'm almost done with this.”
- “Do you have a minute? I'm stuck on something.”
- “Just following up on this. Any update?”

Ask for Clarification Instead of Guessing

- “Sorry, could you say that again?”
- “What do you mean by that?”
- “Just to make sure I understood, you mean...?”

Confirm and Continue

Repeat what you understood and let the other person confirm.

> “So you're saying we should send it by Friday, right?”

Practice: Prepare a two-sentence answer to “Tell me about yourself” using one of the interview openers above.

Quick Win: A short pause and a clear structure make you sound composed, not unsure.

10. Mindset - Practice & Real Conversations

Say It, Fix It, Move On

A mistake doesn't have to stop the conversation.

- “I go... I mean, I went there yesterday.”
- “She don't... doesn't, sorry. She doesn't like it.”

No long apology. No restarting the whole sentence.

Prepare for Your Repeat Situations

Everyday conversations repeat more than you think. Have two lines ready for the situations you face often.

Shop / Restaurant

- “Excuse me, this isn't quite what I ordered.”
- “Could I get this exchanged or refunded?”

Doctor

- “I've been having this problem for about [time].”
- “Is this something I should be worried about?”

Meeting

- “Just to align, the plan is [X], correct?”
- “Let's circle back on this by [date].”

The Real Goal

Not perfect grammar. It's noticing that speaking feels easier than it did a month ago.